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From: Mr. A. Fenner Brockway, M.P. (Eton and Slough)
8, Hillside Gardens,
London, N.6.

House of Commons,
London, S.W.1

1. Int Ack 21/xii

2. Japan Dept.

December 19, 1951.

20/12.

Dear Mr. Eden,

I am writing you directly because Parliament is not in session.

I want to draw your attention to grave reports which appear in the press this morning that Mr. John Foster Dulles, during his "fact finding tour" in Japan has been exerting strong pressure upon the Japanese Government not to trade with the mainland of China, to recognise the Chiang Kaishek Government in Formosa and to proceed with rearmament.

Mr. Dulles is reported to have said at a press conference last week that a considerable development of Japan's trade with Communist China would constitute "a formidable obstacle" to the ratification of the Japanese Treaty in Washington. Both he and Senator Alexander Smith, who accompanied him, are also reported to have insisted that Japan's failure to rearm would create a very bad impression and it is stated that Mr. Dulles seems to have urged the Japanese Government "not only to shun contact with the Chinese Government in Peking but to recognise Chiang Kaishek's Government in Formosa."

I understood that after conferences with Mr. Herbert Morrison, whilst the Japanese Treaty was being drafted, Mr. John Foster Dulles agreed that Japan would have complete freedom of action in deciding its relations to the Chinese Government in Peking and to the Chiang Kaishek Government in Formosa. Indeed, it was on this assurance that the Treaty was signed in San Francisco.

May I express the hope that you will make immediate enquiries regarding these reported statements by Mr. John Foster Dulles and will indicate that the British Government stands by its previous decision that Japan should be free to recognise and trade with the Chinese Government in Peking if it considers that such actions would be in its own best interests and in the interests of the peace of the world.

I will add only that the reported activities of Mr. Dulles are specially unfortunate whilst the cease-fire negotiations in Korea are still proceeding.

Sincerely yours,

Fenner Brockway

Rt.Hon. Anthony Eden, M.P.
Secretary of State for Foreign Affairs.

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